



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Aletheia United Academy
School Website: <https://aletheiaunitedacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Aletheia United Academy (Charlottesville, VA 22902) presents a clearly classical-leaning program grounded in a Christian, biblically centered worldview. Across the six classical elements, the school demonstrates strong alignment with orthodox classical aims: it foregrounds the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a liberal-arts approach; it treats formation (virtue, wisdom, character) as the telos of education; it emphasizes integrated subjects anchored by Scripture; it employs a traditional pedagogy anchored in classical methods; it presents a defined faculty structure (board, trained teachers, collaborative home-school model); and it actively engages parents as part of a shared educational project. There are explicit references to truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and a shared commitment to formation over mere information, and a robust partnership with families is repeatedly emphasized. These signals collectively support a CLASSICAL rating, with a coherent plan to cultivate a biblical, transcendent frame for learning, memory, and liberal-arts formation.

Key takeaways by category, with evidence anchored to the school's public materials and cross-checked against the classical criterion lexicon and keyword lists:

- **Religious and Metaphysical Foundations:** Strong CLASSICAL signals (biblical worldview, Christ-centered, God's Word, theology). The site explicitly frames education within a biblical worldview and a Christ-centered community, with Morning Assembly and a theology-centered philosophy. Positive signaling words include biblical worldview, gospel, Word of God, Jesus Christ, and Scripture. The knowledge-base lexicon emphasizes truth, goodness, beauty and theology as core anchors; the school's materials align with these themes.
- **Purpose and Goal:** Strong CLASSICAL signals focusing on formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, and the true/good/beautiful, with explicit aim of forming disciples who love God and neighbor. The mission statements foreground formation and character, not merely job-readiness, and quote a transcendent telos tied to truth and divine order. Positive keywords (formation, virtue, wisdom, the true/good/beautiful) are present; the site also frames education as unity under a biblical worldview.
- **Curriculum:** Strong CLASSICAL signals. The school describes a Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) approach, a Humanities core (History, Literature, Theology, Writing), and an emphasis on rigorous liberal-arts education, including Great Books/Great Conversation framing and a biblically integrated worldview. Evidence includes explicit reference to Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric in academics and the Great Books/Great Conversation framing in philosophy and curriculum discussions.
- **Pedagogy/Teaching Methods:** CLASSICAL orientation is evident, with explicit reference to classical pedagogy and the Trivium, and to a collaborative home/classroom model. The site cites Dorothy Sayers and the Lost Tools of Learning as the pedagogical foundation, and emphasizes a structured progression through Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, with an emphasis on integrated, teacher-guided instruction and a partnership with co-teaching parents. While explicit terms like "Socratic seminars" and "Scholé"

are not consistently visible on every page, the core pedagogy aligns with classical methods and with a high-rigor, seminar-like development of reasoning and rhetoric.

- Faculty: CLASSICAL signals are strong. Public materials describe a professional teaching team, a board of directors, and a collaborative model with co-teaching parents; there is emphasis on teachers as mentors and living curriculum, with a well-defined governance structure (board) and a collaborative culture with families. The site describes the board and trained educators and the “co-teaching parent” model.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL signals are strong. The school highlights partnership with families, home/classroom bridging, parental formation, and open campus visitation in the context of a classical education ethos. The site stresses parent involvement as co-teachers and integral to the education model.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

In aggregate, Aletheia United Academy demonstrates a coherent classical orientation across all six categories, with explicit articulation of Trivium-based pedagogy, Great Books/Humanities alignment, formation as telos, a biblically grounded worldview, professional faculty, and strong parent-community partnership.

What would move the needle: Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category currently appears to be NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, given the explicit alignment across categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a biblical worldview and Christ-centered education, with references to the Word of God, gospel, and morning assemblies anchored in Christian worship/education. - Mission and Philosophy sections describe faith-integrated education, God-centered formation, and a doctrinal framework for learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found on site: biblical worldview, gospel, Word of God, Jesus Christ, Scriptures, theology, worship, and Christ-centered. These align with the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (truth/goodness/beauty are anchored, but the site uses “truth” in the sense of divine truth rather than secular relativism). The lexicon lists truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder as positives; the site’s language maps to these concepts. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in public materials; the school’s materials do not emphasize secular relativism or value-neutral ethics. The formal negative indicators in the lexicon (relativism, secular humanism) are not foregrounded on the site.

Why this rating - The material is saturated with religious foundations (biblical worldview, God-centered, gospel-driven), clearly aligning with Transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community life in practice. The presence of liturgical/communal elements (Morning Assembly; Psalm-based or Scripture-centered routines) and theology-integrated pedagogy strongly supports Classical in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not primarily job preparation; the mission centers on loving God and neighbor and forming disciples who think and act in alignment with a biblical teleology. - The philosophy emphasizes truth, unity of knowledge, and formation (not fragmentation), with a telos grounded in classical aims and Christian formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education, Great Conversation, classical mission. The site repeatedly emphasizes formation and a classical frame. The Six Elements lexicon lists formation, cultivation of wisdom/virtue, and pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as core positives; the site's language maps to those values. - Negative keywords present: none explicit; the site does not foreground "career readiness" or "21st-century skills" as primary telos; rather, it centers formation and biblical truth.

Why this rating - The school consistently positions education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, rooted in a transcendent truth and beauty model, rather than solely preparing for work or information transfer. This aligns with CLASSICAL as the intended aim.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicitly uses the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as the spine of the curriculum, with a schedule and level structure (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and a Humanities core that includes History, Literature, Theology, and Writing. - Emphasizes integration of Great Books/Great Conversation and a biblical worldview across disciplines (the materials describe studying "great literature of our Christian heritage" and a unified curriculum around Scripture). - Acknowledges historic/ liberal-arts breadth (math/science/foreign language CORE+ courses; electives) and a culture of wonder in learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), great books / great conversation, history, liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, theology, sacred tradition, wonder, integrated curriculum, classical pedagogy. These map to the Positive keyword indicators in the Six Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords present: the site does not foreground project-based learning or purely STEM-first framing; the public materials emphasize integration and liberal-arts breadth instead of a narrowing, non-classical approach. (The lexicon lists "negative" signs for social studies emphasis instead of history, but the site's history emphasis appears integrated rather than replaced.)

Why this rating - The curriculum centers on the liberal arts, the Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, and a unified, scripture-centered approach. The evidence aligns strongly with a CLASSICAL curriculum profile.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Claims of classical pedagogy (Dorothy Sayers; Lost Tools of Learning) are explicit, with a three-stage progression and a commitment to imparting the basics (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in alignment with child development. - Public materials describe the formal structure of grades with a focus on memory work, reasoning, and rhetorical development, and a blended home/classroom model that supports disciplined study and accountability.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Socratic dialogue, great conversation, guided discussion, logic and debate, rhetoric, memory, scholé/restful learning, formation through imitation, copying/teacher-led exemplars, memorization/recitation. The Six Elements lexicon lists these methods as core positive pedagogical indicators; the site references classical pedagogy and rhetorical training. - Negative keywords present: minimal explicit reliance on experiential/project-based learning; the site emphasizes traditional, teacher-guided instruction and classical activity rather than constructivist or student-led experiential frameworks. The lexicon flags experiential/project-based learning as a negative signal, and the site's emphasis on order, form, and memory suggests a lower alignment with those negatives.

Why this rating - The pedagogy is firmly rooted in classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books framing, memory work, and teacher-guided instruction within a collaborative home-school model). This places it in CLASSICAL territory.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The website describes professional teachers in a collaborative framework with the home, board governance, and a disciplined, mission-aligned staff. The “Our Story” and “Mission, Vision, & Philosophy” sections frame the faculty as part of a collaborative effort with parents and a governance board. - It emphasizes the living curriculum and virtue modeling by faculty, and a culture of mentorship and accountability in a classical frame. The co-teaching parent model underscores a faculty-partner relationship with students and families.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, mentorship, virtue, discipline, professional educators, board leadership, teacher as mentor, collaborative culture. The lexicon’s Faculty indicators emphasize model teachers, living curriculum, and mentorship; the site’s language aligns with these. - Negative keywords present: none prominent; the site does not reflect “facilitators” or non-classical faculty roles; governance and teacher leadership appear clearly.

Why this rating - The materials portray a standard of professional, virtuous, and teacher-led formation consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A central pillar is partnership with families; the site explicitly describes collaboration with co-teaching parents and bridging home and classroom. The Learn@Home days and the home/classroom partnership are repeatedly foregrounded. - The materials describe parent formation, home-school collaboration, and parental involvement through a shared mission; parents are co-educators in the classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with families; co-teachers; home-school collaboration; parental engagement; families as co-educators; household formation; parent formation; classical family culture. These entries map to the Positive Keywords categories in the lexicon (Partnership with Families; Formation within the home; community practices). - Negative keywords present: none; the site presents an open, collaborative campus with parental involvement and accessibility; “customer” language or minimal parent access is not evident.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds partner-with-parents as core to its mission and pedagogy, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for community and family formation.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable (the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL). If needed in the future, potential needle-moving steps (for a stronger, more explicit CLASSICAL alignment) could include: - Articulate explicit references to Scholé and Socratic seminars in high-school pedagogy with examples of memory work and recitation as core activities. - More explicit Great Books/Renaissance-era canonical texts as part of core courses with direct evidence of intertextual reading lists. - A public, explicit statement about liturgical practices (e.g., regular chapel services or liturgical calendars) as a formal element of the school’s daily life.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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